University of New Haven

POMPEA COLLEGE OF BUSINESS

Marketing

Course Information
MKTG XXX
Marketing Research
Fall 2026
Credit Hours: 3

Faculty Contact Information
Instructor: Dr. Hesam Teymouri
Email: XXX
Classroom: X
Class Meeting Time: XXX

COURSE SYLLABUS

Course Description
This course provides an introduction to the theory and practice of marketing research and its role in managerial decision making. The course covers the systematic process of generating, analyzing, and interpreting information to support marketing decisions. Topics include problem formulation, exploratory research, secondary data analysis, qualitative and quantitative research design, measurement and scaling, questionnaire design, sampling, data collection, statistical analysis, and communication of research results.

The course emphasizes the application of marketing research methods to real-world business problems. Students will complete a semester-long research project in which they design and conduct a marketing research study following the full research process. Basic statistical concepts commonly used in marketing research, including sampling distributions, normal distribution, hypothesis testing, correlation, and regression, are introduced with emphasis on interpretation and managerial relevance.

By the end of the course, students will be able to design marketing research studies, evaluate data, interpret results, and communicate insights that support effective marketing decisions.

Course Introduction:
Organizations rely on information to make effective marketing decisions. Managers must understand customer needs, evaluate market opportunities, test new ideas, and measure performance in order to compete successfully. Marketing research provides the tools and methods used to collect and analyze information that supports these decisions. In practice, however, relevant information is often incomplete, uncertain, or difficult to measure. Important

factors such as customer attitudes, preferences, satisfaction, and purchase intentions cannot always be observed directly and must be studied using carefully designed research methods. As a result, effective marketing research requires a combination of data, theory, critical thinking, and appropriate analytical techniques.

The primary objective of this course is to help students understand how marketing research is used to support data-driven decision making in organizations. Students will learn the complete marketing research process, including problem formulation, exploratory research, secondary data analysis, research design, measurement, questionnaire development, sampling, data collection, statistical analysis, and reporting results. The course emphasizes the practical use of research methods rather than mathematical derivations, with a focus on how managers interpret research findings to make informed decisions.

Throughout the semester, students will work on a semester-long research project in which they design and conduct a marketing research study from start to finish. This project will require students to define a research problem, collect and analyze data, and present their findings in a professional report and presentation. Because marketing research is often conducted in teams in professional settings, students will complete the project in groups and develop skills in collaboration, communication, and project management.

The course also introduces basic statistical concepts commonly used in marketing research, including sampling distributions, normal distribution, hypothesis testing, correlation, and regression. These topics will be taught at a conceptual level with emphasis on interpretation and application rather than mathematical proofs. The goal is to help students become informed users of research who can understand results, evaluate evidence, and apply insights in real-world marketing situations.

Enrollment in the course is an agreement to abide by and accept all terms. Remember that you may elect to drop or withdraw from this course before the end of the drop/add period.

Recommended Text(s)/Materials/Supplies

Textbook:
Brown, Tom J., Tracy A. Suter, and Gilbert A. Churchill.
Basic Marketing Research, 9th Edition.
Cengage Learning.

Students are expected to read the assigned chapters before class. The textbook provides the conceptual foundation for the course and will be used throughout the semester for assignments, exams, and the semester research project.

Additional Readings:
Additional articles, cases, or notes may be assigned during the semester. These materials will be posted on Canvas. Students are responsible for reviewing all assigned materials and staying up to date with course announcements.

Software / Tools:

Students may be required to use basic data analysis tools during the semester. These may include:

- Microsoft Excel
- Google Forms / Qualtrics (for survey data collection)
- SPSS, R, or similar statistical software (basic use only)
- Canvas for assignment submission and communication

No prior programming or statistical software experience is required.

Supplies:
Students should have regular access to:

- A laptop computer
- Internet connection
- Microsoft Office (or equivalent)
- Canvas

These tools are necessary for completing assignments, working on the semester project, and submitting course work.

Course Goals

Develop the ability to use marketing research to support managerial decision making. This course takes a practical approach to marketing research and focuses on how organizations collect, analyze, and interpret information to solve real business problems. Students will learn how to design marketing research studies, work with both primary and secondary data, and use basic statistical tools to interpret results. The course emphasizes hands-on learning through a semester-long research project in which students apply the marketing research process from problem definition to final report. The goal of the course is to prepare students to become informed users of marketing research who can evaluate data, generate insights, and communicate findings effectively in professional settings.

Course Learning Objectives

- Formulate marketing research problems and translate managerial questions into researchable objectives
- Identify and evaluate appropriate sources of secondary and primary data to address marketing problems
- Design marketing research studies using exploratory, descriptive, and causal research methods
- Develop questionnaires and measurement scales that are reliable and valid
- Select appropriate sampling methods and understand sources of sampling and non-sampling error
- Apply basic statistical concepts, including normal distribution, hypothesis testing, correlation, and regression, to interpret marketing data
- Analyze research results and draw meaningful conclusions to support marketing decisions
- Work collaboratively to design and complete a marketing research project
- Prepare professional written reports and presentations that communicate research findings clearly

- Evaluate the quality and limitations of marketing research studies used in business practice

Course Requirements & Assessment

A. INSTRUCTIONAL METHODOLOGY:

The course will consist of lectures, in-class discussions, and applied exercises designed to help students understand and use marketing research methods in real-world situations. Students will learn the marketing research process through a combination of conceptual material and hands-on activities. The course emphasizes practical application rather than mathematical derivation.

Throughout the semester, students will work on a semester-long marketing research project in which they design and conduct a research study from problem formulation to final report. Several assignments will be completed in teams to reflect how marketing research is conducted in professional settings, where researchers collaborate to collect data, analyze results, and communicate findings. Individual assignments, exams, and the final research project will assess students' understanding of the concepts and their ability to apply research methods to business problems.

B. ATTENDANCE:

This is an in-person course and consistent attendance is expected. Many class sessions include discussions, in-class exercises, and project work that cannot be fully replicated outside of class. Students who miss class may lose participation points and may also miss important instructions related to assignments and the semester project.

For each unexcused absence, 10 points will be deducted from the final grade. Students are responsible for all material covered in class, including announcements and assignment instructions.

If you have a medical condition or emergency that results in multiple absences and you would like the absences to be excused, you must provide documentation to the Dean of Students Office, who will verify the situation and notify the instructor.

Online attendance is not permitted unless approved through the Accessibility Resource Center.

C. COURSE REQUIREMENTS:

Individual Assignments
Students will complete several individual assignments during the semester to reinforce key concepts such as secondary data search, experiment design, measurement, and questionnaire development. These assignments are designed to ensure that each student understands the marketing research process independently of the group project.

Semester Research Project (Team)
Students will work in teams to complete a marketing research project throughout the semester.

The project will follow the full marketing research process, including problem definition, secondary data analysis, research design, questionnaire development, data collection, analysis, and final report. Each team member is expected to contribute equally to the project. Peer evaluations may be used to assess individual contributions.

Midterm Exam
The midterm exam will cover concepts from the first half of the course, including the research process, exploratory research, secondary data, and research design. The exam will include multiple-choice and conceptual questions.

Participation and In-Class Activities
Participation includes attendance, contribution to class discussions, and involvement in in-class exercises. Active participation helps students understand the material and is an important part of the course grade.

Final Research Project – Report and Presentation
Students will work in teams to complete a semester-long marketing research project. The purpose of this project is to give students hands-on experience with the full marketing research process, from problem definition to final report. Each team will design and conduct a marketing research study on a topic approved by the instructor.

The final project will include both a written report and an in-class presentation. The project should demonstrate the team's ability to apply the concepts learned in the course and to communicate research findings in a professional manner.

Final Presentation Requirements

Each team will give a class presentation summarizing their research project. The presentation should clearly explain the research problem, the research design, the data collected, the analysis performed, and the conclusions.

The presentation should include the following sections:

1. Research Problem and Objectives
- Describe the marketing problem being studied
- Explain why the problem is important
- State the research objectives and research questions

2. Background and Secondary Data
- Summarize relevant information collected from secondary sources
- Explain how existing data helped define the research problem

3. Research Design
- Identify the type of research (exploratory, descriptive, causal)
- Explain the chosen research method
- Define the variables being measured

4. Questionnaire and Measurement

- Describe how the survey or data collection instrument was designed
- Explain the scales used to measure variables
- Provide examples of key questions

5. Sampling Plan and Data Collection

- Describe the target population
- Explain the sampling method used
- Report the number of responses collected

6. Data Analysis

- Present summary statistics and graphs
- Show results of basic statistical analysis
- Interpret the results in plain language

7. Conclusions and Managerial Implications

- Explain what the results mean
- Describe how the findings could be used in a real marketing decision
- Provide recommendations based on the research

8. Limitations and Future Research

- Discuss weaknesses of the study
- Suggest how the research could be improved

9. Professional Quality

- Presentations should be clear, organized, and professional.
- Slides should be easy to read and should include tables, charts, or figures when appropriate.

Each team member must participate in the presentation.

Written Report

- In addition to the presentation, each team must submit a written research report.
- The report should include the same sections as the presentation but in more detail.
- The report must be well organized, clearly written, and formatted in a professional manner.

Team Contribution

All team members are expected to contribute equally to the project.
Peer evaluations may be used to adjust individual grades if necessary.

Failure to participate in the group project may result in a reduced grade.

All assignment instructions and due dates will be posted on Canvas. Students are responsible for checking Canvas regularly.

D. LATE WORK AND MAKE UP POLICY:

Assignments must be submitted by the deadline listed in Canvas. Late assignments will not be accepted unless prior arrangements are made with the instructor.
Make-up exams will not be given without an approved university excuse. Students should contact the instructor as soon as possible if they are unable to complete an assignment due to illness or emergency.

E. GROUP WORK POLICY:

Because marketing research is often conducted in teams, several assignments in this course will be completed in groups. All students are expected to contribute to their team's work and participate in meetings and project activities.
If a student does not contribute to the group project, the instructor may adjust that student's grade based on peer evaluations or require the student to complete work individually.
Professional and respectful communication is expected in all group interactions.

Expectations

Ability to manage time effectively and keep up with readings, assignments, and project work throughout the semester

- Willingness to learn through lectures, discussions, in-class exercises, and applied research activities
- Ability to work cooperatively in team-based research projects and group class activities
- Basic familiarity with statistics concepts such as averages, percentages, and graphs
- Ability to use Microsoft Excel or similar software for basic data analysis
- Ability to use online tools for survey data collection (such as Google Forms or Qualtrics)
- Access to a laptop computer for completing assignments and working on the semester project

This course will require significant in-class and out-of-class commitment from each student. The University estimates that students should spend approximately two hours outside of class for every hour spent in class. For a three-credit course, this means students should expect several hours of additional work each week for reading, assignments, and the semester research project.

Success in this course requires consistent effort throughout the semester.

Grading

Grades earned are based on your performance on homework, quizzes, exams and the final exam.

Gradable Component	Description	Points
Midterm Exam (Individual)	Exam evaluating students' understanding of the marketing research process, problem formulation, secondary data, and research design concepts.	150
Final Exam (Individual)	Comprehensive exam evaluating students' understanding of marketing research concepts, data analysis, interpretation of	150

Gradable Component	Description	Points
	results, and the application of research methods to business problems.	
Individual Assignments (4 total)	Individual assignments designed to reinforce key concepts such as secondary data search, experiment design, measurement, and questionnaire development. Each assignment is worth 50 points.	200
Group Project Milestones (4 total)	Team-based assignments completed throughout the semester as part of the research project, including topic proposal, secondary data report, research design plan, and questionnaire development.	150
Final Research Project (Report + Presentation)	Final team research project including written report and class presentation demonstrating the complete marketing research process from problem definition to data analysis and managerial implications.	250
Participation & In-Class Activities (Individual)	Participation in discussions, in-class exercises, and project activities. Includes attendance and contribution to team work.	50
Peer Evaluation (Team Contribution)	Team members evaluate each other's participation, effort, and contribution to the semester research project.	50
Total		**1000**

Late submissions will get 20% reduction penalty. Do not wait for the last day to complete and submit your assignments.

Final Grades are assigned with the following scale:

Undergraduate Scale

Grades Scored Between	Letter Equivalents
93 to 100	A
90 to Less than 93	A-
87 to Less than 90	B+
83 to Less than 87	B
80 to Less than 83	B-
77 to Less than 80	C+
73 to Less than 77	C
70 to Less than 73	C-
67 to Less than 70	D+
63 to Less than 67	D
60 to Less than 63	D-

Graduate Scale

Grades Scored Between	Letter Equivalents
93 to 100	A
90 to Less than 93	A-
87 to Less than 90	B+
83 to Less than 87	B
80 to Less than 83	B-
77 to Less than 80	C+
73 to Less than 77	C
70 to Less than 73	C-
Less than 70	F

Course Outline/Schedule

Week	Topics / Details Covered	Book Chapters	Assignments
1	Introduction to marketing research; role of marketing research in managerial decision making; types of marketing research; overview of the research process	Ch. 1	—
2	The marketing research process in detail; ethics in marketing research; the role of research in business decision making	Ch. 2	**Individual Assignment 1:** Research in the News
3	Problem formulation; defining the research problem; developing research objectives; exploratory research; literature search; focus groups; depth interviews	Chs. 3–4	**Group Project Milestone 1:** Topic Proposal
4	Secondary data; internal and external data sources; decision support systems; customer relationship management; advantages and limitations of secondary data	Chs. 5–6	**Individual Assignment 2:** Secondary Data Search Report
5	External secondary data sources; syndicated data; panels; online databases; using secondary data to support marketing decisions	Ch. 7	**Group Project Milestone 2:** Secondary Data Report
6	Causal research; experimental design; independent and dependent variables; validity issues; A/B testing and applications in marketing	Ch. 8	**Individual Assignment 3:** Experiment Design Exercise
7	**Midterm Exam** covering Weeks 1–6	—	—
8	Descriptive research; survey research; observation methods; behavioral data; communication versus observation approaches	Chs. 9–10	**Group Project Milestone 3:** Research Design Plan

9	Survey methods; interviews; online surveys; structured and unstructured questions; data collection methods	Ch. 11	—
10	Measurement and scaling; nominal, ordinal, interval, and ratio scales; reliability; validity; measurement error	Ch. 12	**Individual Assignment 4:** Scale and Question Writing Assignment
11	Questionnaire design; question wording; response formats; order effects; sources of bias; questionnaire layout; pretesting	Ch. 13	**Group Project Milestone 4:** Final Questionnaire Submission
12	Sampling methods; probability and nonprobability sampling; sample size; sampling error; response error; data quality issues	Chs. 14–15	Project Data Collection
13	Data preparation; coding; cleaning; missing data; introduction to sampling distribution; normal distribution; standard error	Chs. 16–17	Project Data Preparation
14	Hypothesis testing; p-value; statistical significance; t-tests; correlation; regression; interpretation of results in a marketing context	Chs. 17–18	Project Data Analysis
15	Writing research reports; visualizing findings; presenting results; communicating managerial implications; final project presentations	Chs. 19–20	Final Group Project Report and Presentation
16	Final Exam	—	—

Due to unforeseen circumstances, it may be necessary to alter the outlined schedule of activities, assignments, tests, quizzes and presentations etc. during the semester. Any such changes will be clearly communicated to the class.

Diversity Statement

The University of New Haven embraces diversity and recognizes our responsibility to foster a diverse, inclusive, and welcoming environment in which all members of the Charger community of all backgrounds and identities can learn, work, and live together. We benefit from the academic, social, and cultural developments that arise from a diverse campus that is committed to equity, inclusion, belonging, and accountability.

We have a responsibility as a community and as individuals to address and remove barriers, achieve success, and sustain a culture of inclusivity, empathy, kindness, and compassion. We encourage, welcome, and embrace participation in ongoing dialogue, engagement, and education to critically examine and thoughtfully respond to the changing realities of our community. Diversity, equity, inclusion, acceptance, and belonging enrich the Charger community and are instrumental to institutional success and fulfillment of the University mission.

Reporting Bias Incidents

At the University of New Haven, there is an expectation that all community members are committed to creating and supporting a climate which promotes civility, mutual respect, and open-mindedness. There also exists an understanding that with the freedom of expression comes the responsibility to support community members' right to live and work in an environment free from harassment and fear. It is expected that all members of the University community will engage in anti-bias behavior and refrain from actions that intimidate, humiliate, or demean persons or groups or that undermine their security or self-esteem.

If you have an immediate safety concern for yourself or others, and/or believe someone poses an immediate threat to themselves or others, please contact University Police at 203-932-7070 or call 911. Community members can report bias-motivated incidents by completing the form at **www.newhaven.edu/biasreporting**. Community members are encouraged to complete this form if they are the target of bias or harassing behaviors, witness such behaviors, or gain knowledge of these behaviors occurring within the University community. All matters concerning bias and harassment will be handled by the Dean of Students Office and Human Resources Office.

University-wide Academic Policies

A continually-updated list of University-wide academic policies and descriptions of key university student resources, can be found on Canvas. You can access them by simply clicking on the (?) help button.

The University-wide academic policies include (but are not limited to) the University's attendance policy, procedures for both adding / dropping a course and course withdrawals, an explanation for the sorts of circumstances where incomplete (INC) grades could be considered by the faculty, and the academic integrity policy (among others). Also in this location you will find information regarding the process for reporting bias and topics related to our maintaining a positive learning environment (including, but not limited to, discrimination and sexual misconduct).

The list of key university student resources to enable learning include (but are not limited to) the University's Center for Student Success, Writing Center, Center for Learning Resources, and the Accessibility Resource Center.

Course Delivery Options (choose the statement that describes the modality of *your* course).

For courses with a location of ONLI that also list time and day information, students should plan to be available during that time for synchronous online learning. Classes with no time listed are asynchronous, fully online, and coded ONLI. Due to social distancing requirements, some courses will be offered in Hybrid or Flex formats. ***Online learning may occur at any time, depending on how the University may determine classes are best taught under any circumstance.*** *All courses, including selected labs, practicums, project-based, and clinical courses may require limited, additional meeting times to accommodate accreditation, regulatory, and similar requirements and students will be advised about this at the beginning of those classes.*

Hybrid: Students attend in-person for half of the scheduled course time and the other half of the class content is available online. Students are only required to attend in-person on their designated day(s) and students **need not attend classes virtually**.

Online asynchronous (ONLI): Fully online asynchronous course with **no live, required class sessions**.

Remote synchronous (ONLI with specific meeting time): Fully online synchronous course. **Students attend virtually at the assigned class time.**

Flex: Half of the students attend each class session in-person and the other half attends virtually at the same time.

On-Ground: Fully on-ground course with every student meeting in-person.

Clinical/Laboratory: Practical courses that have an on-ground required component.

UNIVERSITY STUDENT SUPPORT SERVICES

The University recognizes that students can often use some help outside of class and offers academic assistance through several offices.

Accessibility Resources Center

Students with disabilities, chronic health-related conditions, or military service-connected disorders are encouraged to share, in confidence, information about course specific approved reasonable accommodations. The Accessibility Resources Center, located in Sheffield Hall, is responsible for and committed to providing supports and resources that serve to promote educational equity and ensure that students are able to participate in the opportunities available at the University of New Haven. Reasonable accommodations are not made without written documentation from the Accessibility Resources Center.
The Accessibility Resource Center can be reached at (203) 932-7332 or by email at AccessibilityResCtr@newhaven.edu. For additional information, please refer to the Accessibility Resource Center (ARC) website at www.newhaven.edu/campusaccess. For additional assistance from the Dean of Students Office, please contact: deanofstudents@newhaven.edu. If you require assistance with the technology requirement, please visit the Student Technical Support page.

Center for Learning Resources (CLR)

The Center for Learning Resources (CLR), located in the Peterson Library, provides academic content support to the students of the University of New Haven using metacognitive strategies that help students become aware of and learn to apply optimal learning processes in the pursuit of creating independent learners. CLR tutors focus sessions on discussions of concepts and processes and typically use external examples to help students grasp and apply the material.

Center for Student Success (CSS)
The Center for Student Success provides students with a multitude of resources available on cam pus and assists students in fulfilling their educational, social and personal goals.

Counseling & Psychological Services (CAPS)
CAPS offers confidential, free services in order to support student mental health and wellbeing. The services include individual and group therapy, support groups, consultations, and 24/7 crisis support. We are available in person and remotely, and are in the office M-F, 8:30-4:30. Please call us to schedule an appointment or with any questions at 203-932-7333; you can also schedule online. If you experience a mental health crisis after hours, you can call our main number for support.

Myatt Center
The Myatt Center for Diversity and Inclusion is committed to creating a multicultural environment through intentional education, campus community engagement, and valuing the unique identities of each member of the Charger Community. Our commitment to diversity is driven by the core values of connection, belonging, inclusivity, equity, acceptance, and accountability. The Myatt Center's focus is to create a respectful and inclusive environment based our awareness and ability to engage with others who are different on many levels including ethnicity, race, sexual orientation, gender, military, religious belief, and life experiences.

Marvin K. Peterson Library
The Library provides access to online databases, e-books, e-journals, electronic U.S. Government Documents, print books, educational
games, and audiovisual materials. A search can be conducted through all these resources at onc e by using the search box "Articles, Books, & More."
The Library provides three floors with individual quiet study space, collaborative group study space, study rooms with technology, whiteboards, Dell desktops, iMacs, scanners, and printers. The entire library is a wireless zone.

Librarians assist in locating relevant sources of information for research papers, thesis, hon ors thesis, and other projects. Librarians answer general reference questions and help with effectively evaluating sources of information. Help is available through a Chat Service , 24/7 Ask a Librarian Service, a Zoom Reference Service, and by E-Mail. Complete the Research Consultation Form to arrange a time convenient for you.

LibGuides are created
to assist students with research. They contain an overview of resources available through the libr ary, as well as tutorials, subject guides, and course specific guides.

University Writing Center
The mission of the Writing Center is to provide high-quality tutoring to undergraduate and graduate students as they write for a wide range of purposes and audiences. Tutors are undergraduate and graduate students who are majoring in a variety of fields across the University. We are here to work with you at any stage in the writing process; just bring in your assignment,

your ideas, and any writing you've done so far. To make an appointment, you can register for an account with our scheduling site https://newhaven.mywconline.com or visit us in person at our desk on the first floor of Peterson Library (just to the left after you enter the library).